ALE IMAGE FORGE · ENTERPRISE

Feature Cookbook

Practical Scenarios & Power Combinations

A feature-by-feature reference for IT technicians. Each section explains what the feature does, a real-world scenario where you need it, and which other features to combine with it to build powerful, fully automated Windows 11 deployments — all from a single application.

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How to Use This Guide

Every feature in ALE Image Forge is useful on its own — but real automation power comes from combining features. This guide presents each feature as a recipe: what it does, when to reach for it, and which other features to wire up alongside it to get the full result. Work through the sections that match your deployment goal and cross-reference the **Combine with** pills to build your configuration step by step.

1 Source & Output

Source ISO + Windows Edition

STEP 1

WHAT IT DOES

Mounts the source Windows 11 ISO, reads the available editions (Home, Pro, Enterprise, Education), and lets you pick which one to extract into the golden image.

SCENARIO

Your organisation uses **Windows 11 Pro** for office staff but **Enterprise** for IT and finance teams. You have one source ISO but need to produce different images.

HOW TO USE

Browse to the ISO, wait for analysis to complete, then select the edition from the dropdown. Save the profile (*gibprofile*), then reload it and change only the edition for the second build.

RESULT

Two ISOs from one source — same apps, same hardening, different edition. No manual WIM surgery required.

COMBINE WITH Output Filename (Step 1) · Group Policy (Step 3) · Product Key (Step 6)

ISO Boot Language & Target OS Language

STEP 1

WHAT IT DOES

ISO Boot Language must match the language pack inside the ISO's boot.wim (auto-detected). **Target OS Language** sets the display language of the deployed Windows instance — these two can differ.

SCENARIO

You have an **en-GB** source ISO (English International). You want to deploy to your Paris office with a **French** display language and to your Shanghai office with **Chinese Simplified**.

HOW TO USE

Leave ISO Boot Language as auto-detected (en-GB). Change *Target OS Language* to fr-FR for the Paris build, then zh-CN for the Shanghai build. Rebuild with the same profile each time.

RESULT

Paris machines boot in French; Shanghai machines boot in Chinese. No 0x8007000D boot crash, no manual language pack installation post-deployment.

COMBINE WITH Timezone (Step 6) · Keyboard Layout Script (Step 2 — Deployment Scripts) · Output Filename (Step 1)

2 Assets

Wallpaper

STEP 2

WHAT IT DOES

Replaces the default Windows wallpaper files (all resolutions including 4K and lock screen) inside the WIM image so every deployed machine shows your chosen wallpaper from the very first login.

SCENARIO

IT wants all company laptops to show the corporate wallpaper with the helpdesk extension number baked in — without relying on Group Policy or login scripts that could fail.

HOW TO USE

Browse to your `.jpg` wallpaper (4K recommended, 3840×2160). The engine replaces `img0.jpg`, `img19.jpg`, `img20.jpg` and the lock screen variant inside the WIM automatically.

RESULT

Brand wallpaper appears at first login — no GPO, no script, no waiting for policy refresh. Works even if the machine is never domain-joined.

COMBINE WITH OEM Branding (Step 6) · Registry — Wallpaper lock (Step 5) · Auto-Logon (Step 4)

```
# Registry entry to prevent users changing the wallpaper (add in Step 5):
# Key:   HKCU\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System
# Value: Wallpaper  = C:\Windows\Web\Wallpaper\Windows\img0.jpg
# Value: WallpaperStyle = 10
```

Staged Apps (First-Boot Installer Queue)

STEP 2

WHAT IT DOES

Copies your EXE/MSI installers into the image at `C:\GIB\Installers\`. On first user login, GIBFirstBoot runs silently and installs each app in order, resuming automatically if the machine reboots mid-install.

SCENARIO

New starters need **Microsoft Teams, Zscaler Client Connector, and a custom LOB application** on day one. You cannot rely on SCCM because the machines may not be on the corporate network during imaging.

HOW TO USE

Click *Add App*, browse to each installer. Set silent arguments (`/S` , `/qn /norestart` , etc.). Set the install order — dependencies first. GIBFirstBoot handles the queue, including reboot-and-resume.

RESULT

User logs in for the first time and sees a progress window installing all apps silently. By the time it closes, the machine is fully provisioned — no IT desk visit required.

COMBINE WITH Auto-Logon (Step 4) · Deployment Scripts (Step 2) · Bloatware Removal (Step 3) · Driver Injection (Step 2)

Public Desktop Files

STEP 2

WHAT IT DOES

Copies any file (shortcuts, PDFs, URL links, scripts) into `C:\Users\Public\Desktop\` inside the image. These files appear on the desktop for every user account on the machine.

SCENARIO

Every deployed machine must have a **shortcut to the IT Service Portal** and a **PDF quick-start guide** on the desktop — visible to any user who logs in, including future domain accounts.

HOW TO USE

Create a `.url` file pointing to your IT portal URL. Add it here along with your PDF. Both land in Public Desktop and are visible to all users immediately after login.

RESULT

Every user on every deployed machine sees the IT portal shortcut and quick-start guide on their desktop from day one — no login script, no GPO required.

COMBINE WITH Wallpaper (Step 2) · OEM Branding (Step 6) · Staged Apps (Step 2)

Driver Injection

STEP 2

WHAT IT DOES

Injects `.inf` driver packages into the WIM offline using `DISM /Add-Driver /Recurse`. Drivers are available from the very first boot — before Windows Update has a chance to deliver them.

SCENARIO

You are deploying to a mix of **Dell OptiPlex** and **Lenovo ThinkPad** hardware. Certain models have USB-C docks and fingerprint readers that Windows cannot find on its own. Machines land in a network-less staging area so Windows Update cannot help.

HOW TO USE

Download the driver pack from the OEM website. Extract to a folder. Add the folder here. The engine recursively scans for `.inf` files and injects all of them — you do not need to specify individual drivers.

RESULT

All hardware is recognised and functional at first boot. No "Unknown Device" in Device Manager, no missing audio, no broken docks.

COMBINE WITH Staged Apps (Step 2) Disable Telemetry (Step 3)

Deployment Scripts

STEP 2

WHAT IT DOES

Copies PowerShell scripts into `C:\Users\Public\Documents\` inside the image and registers a startup trigger so each script runs automatically at first boot (as SYSTEM or the logged-in user, depending on trigger).

SCENARIO

You need to **clean the Recycle Bin every Friday at 10 PM** across all deployed machines. The script needs to be present on the machine and a Windows Scheduled Task needs to be registered — but this must happen automatically without an IT visit.

HOW TO USE

Step A — Create `CleanRecycleBin.ps1`:
`Clear-RecycleBin -Force -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue`

Step B — Create `RegisterCleanupTask.ps1` that registers the scheduled task.

Step C — Add `RegisterCleanupTask.ps1` here with trigger set to *First Boot*. Add `CleanRecycleBin.ps1` as a companion file (Public Documents). On first boot, the registration script runs and creates the weekly task pointing at the cleanup script.

```
# RegisterCleanupTask.ps1 — staged as a Deployment Script (First Boot trigger)
$action  = New-ScheduledTaskAction -Execute "powershell.exe" `
           -Argument "-NonInteractive -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File `"C:\Users\Public\Documents\CleanRecycleBin.ps1`""
$trigger = New-ScheduledTaskTrigger -Weekly -DaysOfWeek Friday -At "22:00"
$settings= New-ScheduledTaskSettingsSet -RunOnlyIfNetworkAvailable:$false
Register-ScheduledTask -TaskName "WeeklyRecycleBinCleanup" `
    -Action $action -Trigger $trigger -Settings $settings `
    -RunLevel Highest -Force
```

RESULT

Every deployed machine automatically registers a scheduled task at first boot. Every Friday at 22:00, the Recycle Bin is emptied with no user interaction and no IT involvement.

COMBINE WITH Scheduled Tasks (Step 2) · Auto-Logon (Step 4) · Staged Apps (Step 2) · BitLocker (Step 6)

Scheduled Tasks

STEP 2

WHAT IT DOES

Registers Windows Scheduled Tasks directly into the image via `SetupComplete.cmd`. Tasks run under SYSTEM or the admin account on a schedule you define — without needing a login script or GPO.

SCENARIO

You want to **run a disk space report every Monday morning** and save it to a network share, and also **clear temp files on every login** — both must be registered without touching each machine individually.

HOW TO USE

In Step 2 → Scheduled Tasks, add each task: give it a name, point it at a script (already staged via Deployment Scripts), set the schedule (daily/weekly/at login/at startup) and the run-as account. The engine generates the `schtasks` commands in SetupComplete.cmd.

RESULT

All tasks appear in Windows Task Scheduler on every deployed machine from the very first boot. No GPO preferences, no Intune, no domain join required.

COMBINE WITH Deployment Scripts (Step 2) BitLocker (Step 6) Auto-Logon (Step 4)

Language Packs

STEP 2

WHAT IT DOES

Injects additional Windows language pack `.cab` files into the WIM using DISM offline, so they are available for selection at first login without requiring internet access or Windows Update.

SCENARIO

You use an en-GB source ISO but deploy to a multilingual office. Users need to be able to switch their display language to **French or Arabic** via Settings, without downloading anything.

HOW TO USE

Download the `Microsoft-Windows-Client-Language-Pack_x64_fr-fr.cab` (and ar-sa) from the Microsoft Update Catalog. Add the CAB files here. The engine injects them offline before the WIM is sealed.

RESULT

Users can go to Settings → Time & Language → Language and switch to French or Arabic without internet. Useful for air-gapped environments or machines that never reach Windows Update.

COMBINE WITH Target OS Language (Step 1) Deployment Scripts — Keyboard layout (Step 2)

3 Customisations

Bloatware Removal

STEP 3

WHAT IT DOES

Removes provisioned UWP app packages (Xbox, Solitaire, News, Weather, Get Help, etc.) from the WIM using `DISM /Remove-ProvisionedAppxPackage`. They never appear on any user profile — not even new accounts created later.

SCENARIO

Deployed machines must not have gaming or entertainment apps. Removing them from the Start menu via GPO still leaves them installed — DISM removal is permanent and reduces the image size.

HOW TO USE

Tick each app to remove. For a corporate image, select all Xbox apps, Solitaire, News, Weather, Get Help, Mixed Reality Portal, and any other consumer-facing apps irrelevant to your workforce.

RESULT

Clean, minimal Start menu. Smaller WIM, smaller ISO. Reduced attack surface. Apps cannot be re-installed via the Store if you also apply the Store lockdown Group Policy.

COMBINE WITH Group Policy — Disable Store (Step 3) · Staged Apps (Step 2) · Disable Telemetry (Step 3)

Disable SMBv1

STEP 3 · SECURITY

WHAT IT DOES

Disables the SMBv1 network protocol (exploited by WannaCry, NotPetya) by writing the appropriate registry value and disabling the Windows feature in the offline WIM.

SCENARIO

Your security team's vulnerability scanner flags SMBv1 as critical on every new machine. You want it gone before the machine is ever connected to the network — not patched after deployment.

RESULT

SMBv1 is disabled from first boot. No ransomware propagation vector via the protocol. Passes CIS Benchmark control without a post-deployment remediation script.

COMBINE WITH Disable Telemetry (Step 3) · BitLocker (Step 6) · Group Policy — USB block (Step 3)

Disable Telemetry

STEP 3 · SECURITY

WHAT IT DOES

Sets the Windows diagnostic data level to Security (0 — minimum) and disables the Connected User Experiences and Telemetry service (`DiagTrack`), preventing data from being sent to Microsoft.

SCENARIO

Your organisation handles sensitive data. The data privacy policy prohibits diagnostic data leaving the building. You need this enforced at OS level — not as a user setting that can be reversed.

RESULT

Windows telemetry is silenced at the registry and service level from first boot. Users cannot re-enable it via Settings — the policy registry key overrides the UI.

COMBINE WITH Disable SMBv1 (Step 3) · Group Policy (Step 3) · Air-gapped — Disable Windows Update GP (Step 3)

Group Policy (Offline Registry Injection)

STEP 3

WHAT IT DOES

Writes registry-backed Group Policy values directly into the offline WIM hives (`HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\...` and `HKCU\SOFTWARE\Policies\...`). Policies are enforced from first boot — no domain, no GPO infrastructure needed.

SCENARIO

You need to **disable USB mass storage, block the Microsoft Store, and force Windows Update to install automatically** on all deployed machines — including workgroup machines that will never join a domain.

HOW TO USE

Click *Add Policy*. Choose Computer or User scope. Enter the registry path under `HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\...` or `HKCU\SOFTWARE\Policies\...`. Common examples below.

```
# Disable USB mass storage (Computer policy)
HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\USBSTOR  →  Start = 4 (DWORD)

# Block Microsoft Store (Computer policy)
HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\WindowsStore  →  RemoveWindowsStore = 1 (DWORD)

# Force Windows Update auto-download + install (Computer policy)
HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\WindowsUpdate\AU  →  AUOptions = 4 (DWORD)

# Disable Task Manager (User policy — applies to default user profile)
HKCU\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System  →  DisableTaskMgr = 1 (DWORD)
```

RESULT

Policies are active the moment Windows boots — even before a user logs in. Works on standalone machines, workgroup machines, and domain-joined machines alike.

COMBINE WITH Bloatware Removal (Step 3) · Registry Changes (Step 5) · Disable SMBv1 + Telemetry (Step 3) · BitLocker (Step 6)

System Defaults (Dark Mode, File Extensions, Hidden Files)

STEP 3

WHAT IT DOES

Pre-sets Explorer and UI defaults for every new user profile: Dark Mode on/off, file extensions visible, hidden files visible. Written to the default user hive so all accounts — including domain accounts created after deployment — inherit these settings.

SCENARIO

Your IT team wants **file extensions always visible** on support/helpdesk machines to make phishing file identification easier (e.g. spotting `invoice.pdf.exe`). And developer machines should default to showing hidden files.

RESULT

Every user who logs into a deployed machine — local account or domain account — inherits the pre-set Explorer defaults. No login script, no GPO, no per-user manual configuration.

COMBINE WITH Registry Changes (Step 5) · Group Policy (Step 3)

4 Admin Account

Admin Username & Password

STEP 4

WHAT IT DOES

Creates (or configures) the local administrator account on the deployed machine. If you use a name other than *Administrator*, a new local account is created, added to the Administrators group, and the built-in Administrator account is also enabled as a fallback.

SCENARIO

Your security policy requires renaming the local admin account away from *Administrator* to make brute-force attacks harder. You want every machine to have a local **ALE-Admin** account with a strong known password for emergency recovery.

HOW TO USE

Type `ALE-Admin` in the Username field. Enter the password. Use *Generate Strong Password* if needed — copy it to your password vault before building.

RESULT

Every machine has a consistent local admin account. IT can log in to any machine for emergency access without knowing a user's password. The password is never stored in plain text in the ISO — it is base64-encoded in SetupComplete.cmd.

COMBINE WITH Auto-Logon (Step 4) · Password Never Expires (Step 4) · BitLocker (Step 6)

Auto-Logon

STEP 4

WHAT IT DOES

Configures the machine to automatically log in as the admin account exactly **once** after OOBE completes. The auto-logon self-disables after the first use — subsequent boots require normal credentials.

SCENARIO

You deploy machines in a warehouse where no IT engineer is present. The machine must **boot → log in → install all apps → be ready for the end user** without anyone touching a keyboard. The user should see a normal login screen on their first use.

HOW TO USE

Enable the *Auto-Logon* toggle. The engine writes `AutoAdminLogon=1`, `DefaultUserName`, and `AutoLogonCount=1` to the Winlogon registry key. After one auto-login the counter reaches 0 and Windows removes the auto-logon setting.

RESULT

Machine arrives in the warehouse, power on → auto-logs into admin account → GIBFirstBoot installs all apps → machine is ready. End user first sees a normal Windows login screen. Zero keyboard interaction from IT required.

COMBINE WITH Staged Apps (Step 2) · Skip OOBE (Step 6) · Deployment Scripts (Step 2) · BitLocker (Step 6)

Password Never Expires

STEP 4

WHAT IT DOES

Sets the `DONT_EXPIRE_PASSWD` flag on the local admin account so Windows never prompts to change it. Applied in SetupComplete.cmd via `Set-LocalUser`.

SCENARIO

Your local **ALE-Admin** recovery account must always be accessible. If the password expires while a machine is offline (e.g. a remote site), IT loses access. Making it non-expiring ensures it is always usable for emergency recovery.

RESULT

The local admin account is always accessible regardless of how long the machine has been offline. Domain password policies do not affect local accounts.

COMBINE WITH Admin Username (Step 4) · BitLocker — Recovery Key Save (Step 6)

5 Registry Changes

Custom Registry Entries

STEP 5

WHAT IT DOES

Writes any registry key/value directly into the offline WIM hives (HKLM Software, HKLM System, or HKCU default user profile) before the image is sealed. Supports REG_SZ, REG_DWORD, REG_EXPAND_SZ, and REG_BINARY.

SCENARIO

You need to **pre-configure your VPN client's server address**, **set the RDP port to a non-default value**, and **disable the Windows lock screen** on kiosk machines — none of these have a Group Policy equivalent, so direct registry writes are the only option.

HOW TO USE

Click *Add Entry*. Choose hive scope. Enter the full key path, value name, type, and data. The engine loads the offline hive, writes with `reg.exe`, then unloads it — no PowerShell, no reboot risk.

```
# Example entries:
# Disable lock screen (HKLM Software)
HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\Personalization  →  NoLockScreen = 1

# Pre-set VPN server (HKLM Software — app-specific)
HKLM\SOFTWARE\YourVPNApp\Config  →  ServerAddress = "vpn.company.com"

# Default browser to Edge (HKCU — applies to every new user profile)
HKCU\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\Shell\Associations\UrlAssociations\https\UserChoice
  →  ProgId = "MSEdgeHTM"
```

RESULT

All registry values are present at first boot. Apps pick up their pre-configuration on first launch. Users never see a "first run" setup wizard for pre-configured applications.

COMBINE WITH Group Policy (Step 3) | Staged Apps (Step 2) | Wallpaper lock (Step 5 + Wallpaper Step 2)

6 Advanced Options

Skip OOBE (Out-of-Box Experience)

STEP 6

WHAT IT DOES

Generates an `Autounattend.xml` that suppresses the Windows setup wizard — no region selection, no account creation screen, no privacy prompts, no "Let's connect you to a network" — Windows installs and boots straight to the desktop.

SCENARIO

You are imaging 200 laptops in a staging room. Each machine must go from power-on to desktop with **zero keyboard input**. Any OOBE prompt means an engineer has to stand there — unacceptable at scale.

RESULT

Machine boots from ISO, Windows installs, OOBE is bypassed entirely, machine boots to desktop automatically. An engineer can start 10 machines and walk away.

COMBINE WITH Auto-Logon (Step 4) | Staged Apps (Step 2) | Admin Account (Step 4) | Product Key (Step 6)

BitLocker

STEP 6

WHAT IT DOES

Stages a BitLocker enablement script as a scheduled task that runs 2 minutes after first boot (as SYSTEM). Waits for TPM readiness, enables BitLocker on C:\ with a recovery password protector, and optionally saves the recovery key to a network path.

SCENARIO

Your organisation's security policy mandates full-disk encryption on all laptops. You cannot pre-encrypt during imaging (the drive isn't finalised yet). You need BitLocker to **activate itself automatically** on first boot — with the recovery key saved to a file server — without any IT interaction.

HOW TO USE

Enable BitLocker toggle. Set *Recovery Key Save Path* to a UNC path (`\\fileserver\BitLockerKeys\`) or leave blank to save locally. The script uses the machine's serial number as the filename so keys are uniquely identifiable.

```
# Recovery key file saved as: C:\BitlockerPassword_L<SerialNumber>.txt
# Or to network share:        \\fileserver\BitLockerKeys\BitlockerPassword_L<Serial>.txt
# Scheduled task runs 2 minutes after first boot, then deletes itself.
```

RESULT

Every laptop encrypts itself on first boot. Recovery keys are filed away by serial number. The scheduled task deletes itself after completion — no ongoing scheduled task left behind. Meets ISO 27001 and CIS Benchmark encryption controls automatically.

COMBINE WITH Auto-Logon (Step 4) | Disable SMBv1 (Step 3) | Disable Telemetry (Step 3) | Password Never Expires (Step 4)

OEM Branding

STEP 6

WHAT IT DOES

Sets the Manufacturer, Model, and Support URL that appear in *System Properties → Support Information* (winver / About This PC). Written to the registry during SetupComplete.cmd.

SCENARIO

Your helpdesk wants users to be able to find the support contact without asking. You want every machine's *About This PC* to show **"Alcatel-Lucent Enterprise"** as the manufacturer and your internal support portal URL — so users know exactly who to call.

RESULT

User presses Win+Pause → sees "Support: support.al-enterprise.com". Asset management is easier because every machine identifies its support owner in the OS itself.

COMBINE WITH Wallpaper (Step 2) · Public Desktop Files (Step 2) · Organisation Name (Step 6)

Power Plan

STEP 6

WHAT IT DOES

Sets the active Windows power plan (Balanced, High Performance, Power Saver, or Ultimate Performance) via `powercfg` in SetupComplete.cmd so the machine wakes to the correct plan from its very first boot.

SCENARIO

Office laptops should use Balanced (battery health). **Build servers and VDI masters** should use High Performance (CPU always at maximum). **Kiosk/floor terminals** should never sleep. Each deployment type needs a different plan pre-set without user access to Power Settings.

RESULT

Correct power behaviour from boot one. Servers don't throttle under build load. Office laptops don't drain batteries in meetings. Kiosks never show a locked screen.

COMBINE WITH Registry — Disable screen lock (Step 5) · Group Policy — Sleep settings (Step 3) · Bloatware Removal (Step 3)

Optional Windows Features (Enable / Disable)

STEP 6

WHAT IT DOES

Enables or disables Windows optional features offline using `DISM /Enable-Feature` and `/Disable-Feature`. Changes are baked into the WIM — features are present (or absent) from the very first boot with no internet or Windows Update needed.

SCENARIO

Developer machines need **WSL2 (Windows Subsystem for Linux) and Hyper-V** enabled out of the box. Server images need **SMB Direct and Windows Search disabled** to reduce resource usage. Each needs a different feature set without relying on users enabling them manually.

COMMON FEATURES TO ENABLE

`Microsoft-Windows-Subsystem-Linux` (WSL2) · `VirtualMachinePlatform` (Hyper-V) · `NetFx3` (.NET Framework 3.5 for legacy apps)

COMMON FEATURES TO DISABLE

`WindowsMediaPlayer` · `Printing-PrintToPDFServices-Features` · `SearchEngine-Client-Package` (Windows Search — VDI)

RESULT

Developer opens a terminal — WSL2 is already there. VDI master has no indexer eating CPU. Legacy app launches without a .NET Framework install prompt. Right feature set, right machine, zero manual steps.

COMBINE WITH Staged Apps (Step 2) | Bloatware Removal (Step 3) | Power Plan (Step 6)

Timezone

STEP 6

WHAT IT DOES

Sets the Windows timezone using `tzutil` in SetupComplete.cmd. The correct timezone is set before any user logs in — important for Kerberos authentication, certificate validity, and scheduled task timing.

SCENARIO

You image in your UK depot but ship machines to India, France, and China. A machine with the wrong timezone will have Kerberos auth failures (5-minute clock skew tolerance), scheduled tasks firing at the wrong local time, and Teams/Outlook showing wrong meeting times.

RESULT

Machine boots in the correct timezone for its destination. Kerberos works, scheduled tasks fire at the right local time, meeting invites display correctly. Build separate profiles per region and change only timezone + Target OS Language.

COMBINE WITH Target OS Language (Step 1) | Scheduled Tasks (Step 2) | Output Filename (Step 1)

Organisation Name & Computer Prefix

STEP 6

WHAT IT DOES

Organisation Name appears in System Properties and is written to the `RegisteredOrganization` registry key. **Computer Prefix** renames the machine at first boot to `<PREFIX>-<SerialNumber>`, giving every machine a unique, identifiable hostname automatically.

SCENARIO

Your asset management system identifies machines by hostname. Currently all new machines come with a random DESKTOP-XXXXX name that means nothing. You want them named **ALE-<SerialNumber>** so every machine is traceable to a physical asset without any manual renaming.

HOW TO USE

Set Computer Prefix = `ALE`. SetupComplete.cmd reads the serial number from WMI and renames the machine to `ALE-<SERIAL>`, then triggers a reboot. Auto-Logon fires on the reboot so the user sees the correct hostname from first use.

RESULT

Every machine has a unique, meaningful hostname from boot one. Asset management, SCCM, Intune, and DHCP logs all show `ALE-SN123456` — identifiable with no extra tagging.

COMBINE WITH Auto-Logon (Step 4) | OEM Branding (Step 6) | Organisation Name (Step 6)

Product Key

STEP 6

WHAT IT DOES

Installs a Volume Licence or KMS product key using `slmgr.vbs /ipk` in SetupComplete.cmd. The machine is activated (or will activate against your KMS server on first network connection) without any manual input.

SCENARIO

Your organisation uses a **KMS key** for volume activation. You want every machine to be activated automatically against your KMS server on first boot — no "Activate Windows" watermark, no user prompts.

RESULT

Machine connects to the network, KMS activates Windows silently. No activation nag, no watermark. Licence compliance is automatic.

COMBINE WITH Skip OOBE (Step 6) | Auto-Logon (Step 4)

Power Combination Reference

The table below shows the most effective feature combinations for common deployment goals. Use it as a quick checklist before building — tick each feature off in the wizard to achieve the outcome in the rightmost column.

Goal	Features to combine	Outcome
Zero-touch deployment	Skip OOBE + Auto-Logon + Staged Apps + Computer Prefix	Machine boots → installs all apps → renames itself → ready for user. No engineer needed.
Security baseline	Disable SMBv1 + Disable Telemetry + BitLocker + Group Policy (USB block) + Bloatware Removal	Encrypted, hardened, minimal-surface machine. Passes CIS Level 1 at first boot.
Corporate identity	Wallpaper + OEM Branding + Organisation Name + Registry (wallpaper lock) + Public Desktop files	Consistent brand on every machine. Support URL in About This PC. IT portal on every desktop.
Recurring maintenance	Deployment Scripts + Scheduled Tasks	Script staged on machine, task registered at first boot. Weekly/daily automation runs forever with no further IT action.
Multi-region rollout	Target OS Language + Timezone + Output Filename (one profile, three builds)	Three ISOs from one profile. Right language, right clock, right filename per region.
Kiosk / terminal	Auto-Logon + Password Never Expires + Power Plan (High Perf.) + Registry (disable lock screen) + Group Policy (disable Task Manager)	Machine boots directly into the kiosk session. Never sleeps, never locks, operator cannot exit.
Developer workstation	Optional Features (WSL2, Hyper-V) + Staged Apps (VS Code, Git, Docker) + Show Hidden Files + Show File Extensions	Developer unboxes, logs in — all tools present, Explorer shows extensions and hidden files. Code on day one.
Air-gapped / offline	Staged Apps + Language Packs + Driver Injection + Group Policy (disable Windows Update) + Disable Telemetry	All software, all drivers, all language packs bundled in the ISO. Machine never needs internet to be fully operational.

Tip — Save a profile for each deployment type. Build your full configuration once, save it as a `.gibprofile` file, and load it for the next build. Change only the fields that differ (edition, language, output filename) and rebuild. One application, one profile library, unlimited deployment variants.

ALE Image Forge · Feature Cookbook · Created by Pavan G S · ALE International · v2.4.1